time that VOC convinced Pandithurai Thevar to support SSNCo. Returning to Madurai two weeks later, he reiterated the views expressed on his earlier visit.[82] In December 1906, VOC was again in Madurai 'awakening its slumbering citizens to a Swadeshi dawn'. In reporting his talk, *Swadesamitran* described him as having brought Swadeshism from north India to the south and praised him as an avatar born for the uplift of the nation.[83]

In March 1907, VOC was in Madras City speaking on the beach with G. Subramania Iyer in the chair. The purpose of his visit, according to a CID report, was 'to canvass shares'. Speaking at length, he traced the history of the Swadeshi movement. As a result of the opposition to the Partition of Bengal, the Swadeshi spirit had worked so well that within a year or so Indians were producing every article thus far imported. More overtly political, VOC situated the revival of India in the larger context of the resurgence of the East. If on earlier occasions (such as the talk at Madurai in September 1906), he had tactically underplayed the aspect of boycott, he was now more forthright. 'Swadeshism could not exist so long as there was no recourse to boycott,' he declaimed. If boycott and Swadeshism were pursued in tandem, it would inevitably result in Swaraj. Once business was taken over, and the Indian people established panchayats, the British would have nothing left to do and would have to pack their bags. 'If boycott was successfully carried out in all branches of life, self-government could be easily attained.'[84] The ultimate goal was never in doubt.

India reported that, after the public meetings in Madras City, VOC would proceed to Pondicherry and other areas on a propaganda tour with the objective of raising capital for SSNCo.[85] Accordingly, at Cuddalore VOC delivered similar lectures with vakils, clerks and students attending in large numbers. In pithy terms VOC pointed out, '[H]ow our country once so famous for its handicrafts of all sorts has gone down so low that we are dependent on foreigners for our very articles of clothing, etc. down to a strap of leather and a nail on our sandals …' He pointed to the need for the formation of limited liability companies—a novel concept to the people.